

You have 30 days. Nobody told you the **queue** is longer.

Your student survival guide to Spanish paperwork: four government systems that don't talk to each other, and the order to do them in.

START HERE · WHAT PASSPORT ARE YOU ON?

ROUTE A

EU, EEA or Swiss

Registration certificate · 3 months · €12 ·
no fingerprints

Your path → p.3, then p.9

ROUTE B

Any other passport

TIE photo card · 1 month · €16.08
· fingerprints

Your path → p.3, then p.7

The 30-day clock is for the ordinary non-EU study route over six months. It runs from entry — or from your favourable resolution, if you applied from inside Spain. EU, EEA and Swiss students follow a different route. Section 01 splits them.

30

DAYS TO APPLY FOR
YOUR TIE

3

REGISTRATIONS:
IMMIGRATION, TOWN
HALL, TRANSPORT

€16.08/€12 3

GOVERNMENT FEE, NON-
EU / EU

TIMES YOU SHOW UP IN
PERSON, NON-EU

What's in here

Fifteen short sections in five parts. Read 01, pick your route, then skip anything not tagged for you.

1

Pick your route

Section 01, page 3. Two minutes.

2

Follow your tag

EU NON-EU EVERYONE

3

Stuck? Jump

Every section stands alone. Start with its TL;DR.

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Everything in Parts 1–4 you can do yourself, for free, through official channels. Part 5 is only there if you'd rather not.

01 • START HERE **EVERYONE**

Pick your route first. Half this guide doesn't apply to you.

Most avoidable mistakes start with following the wrong route. Your nationality decides your paperwork. Choose once, then skip everything not tagged for you.

- TL;DR**
- EU, EEA or Swiss passport → registration certificate, within 3 months.
 - Any other passport → TIE card, normally within 1 month of entry.
 - If one of the four special situations below fits you, check before booking anything.
 - See both routes mapped end to end on page 4.

Which passport are you studying on?

ROUTE A

EU, EEA or Swiss

Staying more than 3 months? You apply for an **EU registration certificate**.

YOU GET	A green paper certificate, not a photo card
FORM	EX-18
FINGERPRINTS	No
FEE	€12
DEADLINE	Within 3 months of entry

[Go to 06 → page 9](#)

ROUTE B

Any other passport

Authorised to study for more than 6 months? You apply for a **TIE**.

YOU GET	A physical photo ID card
FORM	EX-17
FINGERPRINTS	Yes, in person
FEE	€16.08
DEADLINE	Normally within 1 month of entry

[Go to 05 → page 7](#)

WAIT – FOUR SITUATIONS CHANGE YOUR ROUTE ENTIRELY

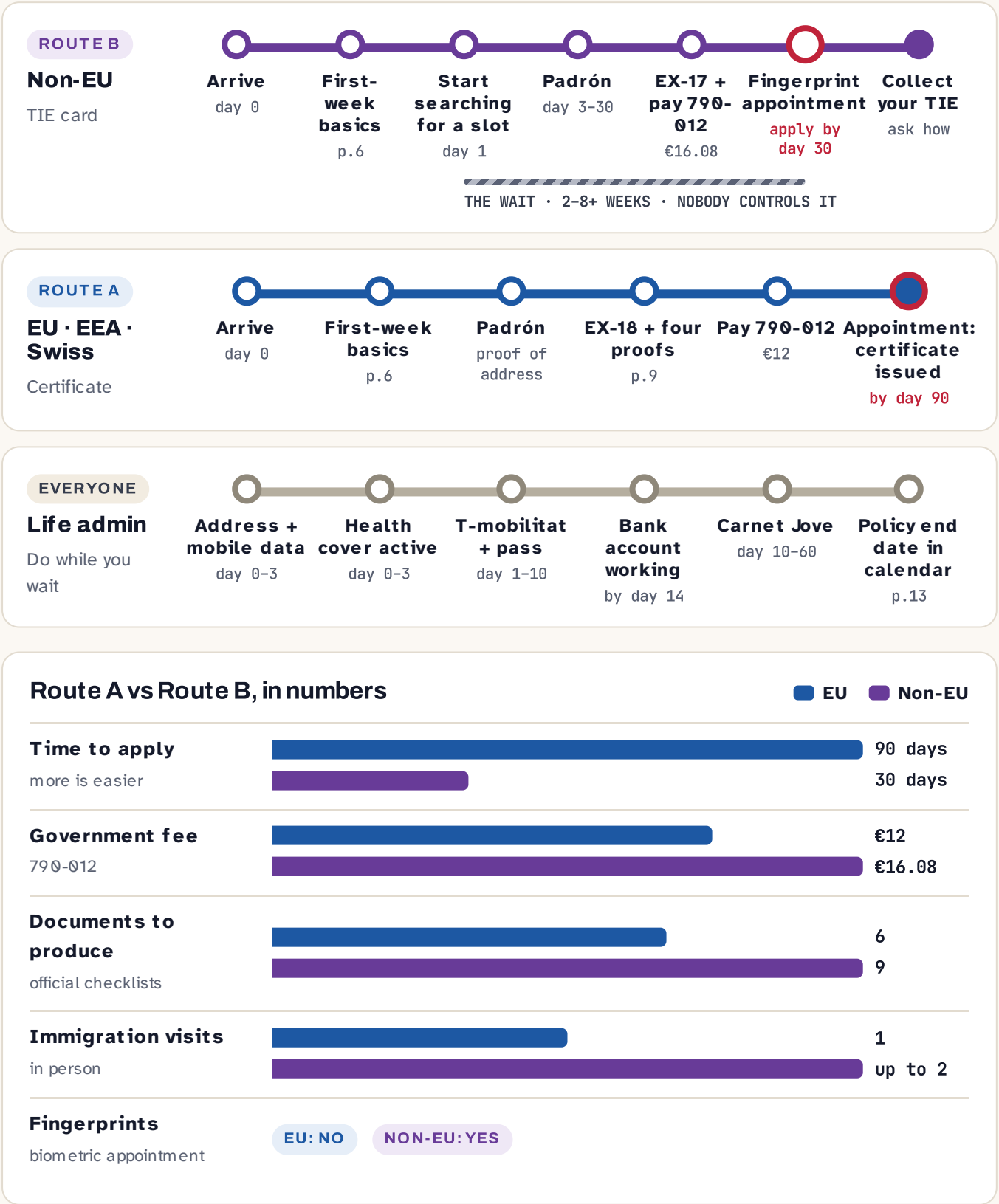
1. You already hold Spanish residence.
2. You have EU-family rights through a spouse or parent.
3. You're on an EU student-mobility arrangement.
4. You applied for your authorisation **from inside Spain**, not at a consulate. Your one-month clock then runs from notification of the favourable resolution, not from entry.

If any of these is you, confirm with your university's international office *before* booking anything. Booking the wrong procedure wastes the appointment and sends you back to the end of the queue.

01 · YOUR ROUTE, MAPPED EVERYONE

Your first term, on one page

Follow your line left to right. Grey stops are for everyone; do them while you wait for your appointment.



02 · THE CLOCK **EVERYONE**

What is due when

Only two of these are legal deadlines. The rest quietly block the next step if you leave them. One of them nobody controls.

- TL;DR** → Non-EU: apply for your TIE within 1 month. EU: register within 3 months.
 → Bank, travel pass and padrón aren't deadlines, but they block other steps.
 → The appointment wait is the only thing you can't speed up. Start searching on day 1.

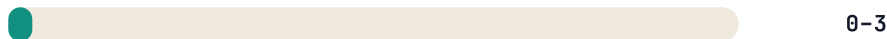
Your first 90 days, to scale

Day 0 = the day you enter Spain

■ Hard legal deadline
 ■ Blocks something else
 ■ Do when convenient
 ■ Nobody controls this

Address + mobile data

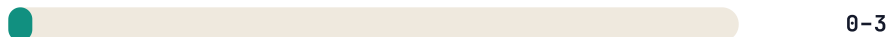
confirm your campus too



0-3

Health cover active

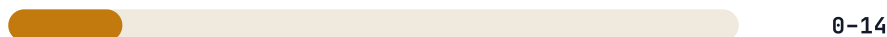
save the assistance number



0-3

Bank account working

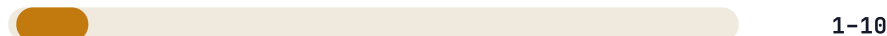
receive money + pay rent



0-14

T-mobilitat + pass

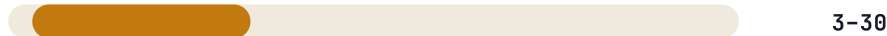
register, then load



1-10

Padrón

town hall address record



3-30

Realistic appointment wait

2-8+ weeks, unpredictable



1-90

Apply for TIE in person

NON-EU

within 1 month of entry*



by 30

EU registration EU

within 3 months of entry



by 90

Carnet Jove

5-9 working days to activate



10-60

day 0 30 60 90

DO THIS FIRST

Start searching for your appointment on your first weekday in Spain. Everything else can happen while you wait.

***CALENDAR NOT COOPERATING?**

Go to section 07, page 10. Missing the window is usually recoverable.

Deadlines reflect the ordinary study routes described by the Ministry and the National Police. Your own authorisation document overrides anything shown here, so read it.

03 · YOUR FIRST WEEK **EVERYONE**

Eight things before any paperwork

None of these involve a government office. They're what makes everything else possible. Tick them off.

- ☐ Ask your landlord or head tenant, **in writing**, whether they'll provide padrón paperwork, before you need it
- ☐ Get working mobile data (home SIM roaming is fine for now)
- ☐ Read your visa or authorisation and **write down your registration deadline**
- ☐ Find your nearest *copistería* (print shop) now, not at 8am on appointment day
- ☐ Email your international office: do they run **group or block TIE appointments** for this intake?
- ☐ Check your health cover is **active in Spain** and save the assistance number
- ☐ Put passport, visa, insurance, enrolment and rental docs in **one folder**
- ☐ Make sure you can **receive money and pay rent** from a working account

04 · VOCABULARY **EVERYONE**

Four words people mix up (and one to photograph)

The most common confusion, and it costs people appointments. Having one of these does not give you the others.

WORD	WHAT IT IS	REMEMBER
 NIE Número de Identidad de Extranjero	A NUMBER Your foreigner ID number. Often already printed on your visa or approval decision.	If it's already there, don't book a NIE appointment. A NIE does not let you stay.
 TIE Tarjeta de Identidad de Extranjero	A PHOTO CARD · NON-EU Proves your authorised status if you're authorised for more than 6 months.	Fingerprints in person · €16.08 · EX-17
 EU registration Certificado de Registro de Ciudadano de la UE	A CERTIFICATE · EU Green paper certificate containing your NIE.	Not photo ID: always carry your passport or national ID too · €12 · EX-18
 Padrón Empadronamiento	AN ADDRESS RECORD · FREE Registers where you live with the town hall. Needed for health services; often asked for at card appointments.	It doesn't fix your immigration status.
 Expediente Número de expediente	YOUR FILE NUMBER On your appointment confirmation and every resolution. Without it, nobody can find you.	Quote it in every email or call. Photograph it the day you get it.

05 · ROUTE B NON-EU

Getting your TIE in five steps

You can't control one of these steps. Start on your first weekday in Spain: the appointment, not the paperwork, is the bottleneck.

- TL;DR**
- Book the **fingerprint** appointment (Toma de huellas), not a NIE one.
 - The 790-012 fee form only counts once it's **paid and stamped** at a bank.
 - Bring originals and paper copies. Screenshots don't count.

1 Read your own authorisation first

The TIE documents a permission you already hold. It doesn't create one. Check the dates and conditions on your visa or approval decision. If your stay is six months or less, you generally don't need a TIE at all.

2 Book the *cita previa* (appointment)

Official appointment portal → Barcelona province → the fingerprint/card procedure, usually labelled **POLICÍA — TOMA DE HUELLAS**. Booking a NIE-number appointment instead is the classic wasted trip.

Slots release irregularly

Check early morning

Keep the confirmation

3 Fill in EX-17 and pay fee 790-012

Download the current EX-17 from the **National Police student-card page**. Generate Modelo 790 Código 012 and select the first-issuance category. **Generating the form is not paying it**: follow the banking instructions and keep the stamped proof.

EX-17

790-012

€16.08

4 Go in person with originals

They check your documents and take your fingerprints. Bring originals *and* a set of paper copies. Names and passport/NIE numbers must match across every document.

5 Ask exactly how you collect it

Some offices need a separate collection appointment. Ask: same day or second appointment? How long is the wait? Where, when, and what to bring? **Don't book flights around an assumed collection date**, and check your re-entry position before travelling with a card still pending.

Who controls each step

● You ● Nobody ● The office

1 · Read

Your authorisation

2 · Book

The wait is unpredictable

3 · Pay

At a bank, stamped

4 · Attend

In person, originals

5 · Collect

Same day or 2nd visit

Next page: exactly what to bring, and the five ways people waste the trip → p. 8

05 • CONTINUED NON-EU

Your appointment-day kit

Pack this the night before. Originals plus paper copies of everything.

Bring all of this

9 ITEMS

- ☐ Appointment confirmation
- ☐ Completed, signed EX-17
- ☐ Original passport + the copies your office asks for
- ☐ Visa / authorisation decision
- ☐ Proof of entry: passport stamp or travel evidence
- ☐ Recent colour photo (spec on the right)
- ☐ **Paid and stamped** 790-012 receipt
- ☐ Padrón certificate, if your office asks for it
- ☐ Current enrolment evidence, if requested

The photo


32 × 26 mm

Plain **white**
background

Face forward

Head uncovered

No tinted lenses

Recent and in colour

Budget about **€6–12** for a set of photos.

Five ways people waste the trip

AVOID THESE

- 1 Wrong appointment type.** Booked a NIE assignment instead of fingerprints.
- 2 Generated but never paid.** The 790-012 needs a bank payment and a stamp.
- 3 Name mismatch.** Middle names on one document, missing on another.
- 4 Digital only.** Relying on your phone when the checklist asks for paper.
- 5 Missing photocopies.** Offices routinely want the passport bio page *and every stamped page*. Copy the lot.

CAN'T FIND AN APPOINTMENT?

There's no legitimate way to guarantee one. What you can do is make sure that when you get one, nothing on your file sends you home again. **Section 07, page 10** covers what to do while you wait.

06 · ROUTE A EU · EEA · SWISS

Your EU registration certificate

Staying more than three months means registering within three months of entry. Shorter, simpler and cheaper than the non-EU route, but not automatic, and a NIE alone doesn't count as done.

TL;DR

- Form **EX-18**, fee **€12**, no fingerprints, deadline **3 months**.
- You need four proofs: enrolment, health cover, resources, address.
- Certificate is normally issued at the appointment. Getting the appointment is the slow part.

1

Complete EX-18

This is the EU registration form. You do *not* use EX-17, and you don't give fingerprints.

2

Gather your four proofs

Enrolment at a recognised institution · comprehensive health cover in Spain · a declaration of sufficient resources · the address/registration evidence your local procedure requires.

Enrolment letter

EHIC or private policy

Resources declaration

Padrón

3

Pay fee 790-012 — €12

Different amount from the non-EU card, same rule: generating the form isn't paying it. Keep the stamped receipt.

4

Book "EU citizen registration" and attend

Book through the official appointment system and go in person with originals and copies. If the requirements are met, the certificate is normally issued at the appointment. That says nothing about how long you'll wait for the appointment itself.

MYTH

"I already have a NIE, so I'm registered."

No. A standalone NIE allocation is not EU registration. If you only need a number for one transaction during a short stay, the separate EX-15 route may fit, but it doesn't replace EX-18 when registration is required.

MONEY SAVER

Your EHIC may be enough

An EHIC can satisfy the health cover requirement if it stays valid for the whole relevant period and gives the required entitlement. **Check with your home insurer** before buying Spanish private cover you may not need. Starting work or changing your residence situation can change this.

07 · WHEN IT WON'T COME NON-EU

The appointment won't come in time

The cover said you have thirty days. In September, the portal often has nothing inside thirty days. Read this before you panic.

THE PART THAT MATTERS MOST

Not to scale

When you're expected to apply

month 1

late applications generally still processed

What protects you

✓ YOUR VISA / AUTHORISATION · THE WHOLE TIME

The TIE card

documents it, later

The one-month window is **not a cliff edge** that voids your right to be here. **The TIE documents a permission you have; it doesn't create one.** So the goal isn't to beat the clock. It's to be able to show, later, that you tried.

Evidence discipline

This is the whole job. Every time the portal shows no availability, **take a dated screenshot**: full screen, date visible. Keep every one in one folder, named by date.

If your file is ever questioned, those screenshots are the difference between "I didn't get round to it" and "here is the system, empty, forty-one times."

How to actually look

Check daily, early. Slots release irregularly and go fast. Ninety seconds every morning beats an hour of refreshing once a week.

Check the procedure every time: fingerprint/card, not NIE-assignment.

Keep looking after you find one. If an earlier slot appears you can usually rebook. Cancel the old one so someone else gets it.

NEVER BUY AN APPOINTMENT

Resold appointments exist because bots scrape the government booking system. In November 2024 the Policía Nacional dismantled one network across Alicante, Murcia and Valencia: **twenty-one arrests**, including for unauthorised access to the state server and document falsification. Buying one puts your file, with your name on it, in the same investigation as the seller's other customers.

When it stops being an admin problem

Talk to a qualified immigration professional (an *abogado* or *gestor administrativo*) if:

- Your authorisation is close to expiring and you still have no appointment
- You need to travel abroad with the card still pending
- You arrived without the authorisation you thought you had
- You've had an application refused, for anything
- You married, changed course or stopped studying

While you wait

Nothing else in this guide is blocked by the appointment. Do the padrón, get the travel pass, open the bank account, check your insurance dates.

The **padrón** is worth doing early: it's free, doesn't depend on the appointment, and several offices ask to see it when you finally get there.

Before travelling abroad with a pending card, check your re-entry position. It's the most common way a manageable situation becomes an expensive one.

08 · THE TOWN HALL

EVERYONE

FREE

Registering your address (the padrón)

Free, quietly required by the step after it, and the one where a difficult landlord can genuinely stall you. Also the part most students get wrong before they've even started.

THE FACT THAT UNLOCKS MOST OF THIS

You don't need to own the property or hold the lease to register. The padrón records where you actually live. It grants no tenancy right and no ownership claim, which is exactly why a landlord's refusal doesn't end the matter, and why their fear of "giving you rights" is misplaced.

Find your situation, then stop reading

Most students who panic about this are on rung 1 and don't know it.

1

EASIEST



effort

The contract is in your name

No landlord involvement needed at all. The contract is your proof, and they already signed it. Bring it with your ID and you're done. If this is you, the rest of this page isn't your problem.

2

MOST
COMMON

effort

You rent a room, or the contract is in someone else's name

You need an **express written authorisation** from the person named on the title or contract: signed original, by an adult, plus a photocopy of their ID showing the same signature.

The authoriser can be the owner *or* the tenant. Neither has to be registered there themselves, but they must evidence their own title. **Your head tenant can authorise you using their own rental contract.** That one sentence resolves most room-rental cases.

3

ROUTINE



effort

You live in a student residence

Authorisation from the establishment's titleholder. Ask reception; they've done it many times. If they say they don't, ask again **in writing** and name the person you spoke to.

4

FALLBACK



effort

You have no documentation at all

There's an official fallback: after you apply, municipal services verify by telephone and a visit to the address.

The trade-offs: it's **slower**, you must be genuinely reachable and genuinely living there, and **your landlord may find out**, because an officer at the door isn't discreet. It works. It isn't frictionless.

08 · CONTINUED **EVERYONE**

Proof, paperwork and the date you'll forget

Other evidence that's accepted

- ☐ *Escritura*: the deed, if you own
- ☐ *Nota simple* from the property register
- ☐ An **IBI** (property tax) receipt
- ☐ A **bank transfer from the last two months** showing rent paid

Not accepted: mobile and internet bills, or a utility bill in someone else's name.

Volant or certificat?

Students bring the wrong one, constantly.

VOLANT

Informative. Fast, often instant online.

CERTIFICAT

Carries *fe pública*: the authenticated document. Separate request, takes longer.

Procedures that need proof ask for the **certificat**. Check your appointment's own checklist. **Unsure? Take the certificat**: it covers anything the volant would.

From booking to renewal

OAC = the town hall's citizen office



Book in week one

OAC appointment (*cita prèvia*). Shorter queue than immigration, not instant.



Register

At the counter, or online with **idCAT** or **Cl@ve**.



~7 days later

Confirmation email; volants now available.



Every 2 years

NON-EU Renew, or it **lapses silently**. Calendar it today.

Your address needs floor and door:

✗ Carrer X 44

✓ Carrer X 44, 3r 2a

NEVER REGISTER AT AN ADDRESS YOU DON'T LIVE AT

Barcelona has recorded falsified rental contracts and utility bills submitted for padrón registration. **Article 392 of the Criminal Code carries prison sentences and fines** for falsifying a document, and it attaches to your immigration file, following you through every renewal you ever apply for. It's not a shortcut.

Catalan vs Spanish: *volant* and *certificat* are the Catalan spellings of *volante* and *certificado*. Same documents.

09 · HEALTH COVER EVERYONE

Does your policy still qualify?

If you're non-EU, you bought insurance at the consulate months ago. This isn't about what to buy. It's whether what you have survives the counter, and when it runs out.

The four rejection criteria

NON-EU

Check your policy against these before your appointment, not at it.

- ☐ **No copayments.** The biggest killer. A policy that charges per visit isn't comparable to public cover.
- ☐ **No waiting periods.** Cover that starts in three months doesn't cover you now.
- ☐ **Insurer authorised to operate in Spain.** A policy from home usually isn't.
- ☐ **Dates cover the full authorised period,** not the academic year. The gap between them is where people get caught.

EU, EEA, Swiss

EU

An EHIC can satisfy the requirement if it stays valid for the whole relevant period and gives the required entitlement. Check with your home insurer rather than assuming.

Two things change this: **starting work** and **changing your residence situation**. Both are worth a five-minute call first.

Where people get caught

Illustrative

Authorised period

WHAT YOUR POLICY MUST COVER

Policy bought for the academic year

COVERED

GAP REJECTED

YOUR VISA POLICY MAY NOT GET YOU YOUR RENEWAL

Some extranjería offices apply the criteria more strictly at renewal than the consulate did, and some prefer Spanish insurers. If your policy came from a broker at home, find out now what renewing looks like, not eleven months from now.

Diarise your policy end date today. It's the most commonly missed date in this entire guide.

You may be paying twice

Once you're on the padrón in Catalonia, many students can access **CatSalut** public healthcare and get a *targeta sanitària* (TSI). This does **not** replace the insurance your authorisation requires.

You may have a public route for ordinary care. Check with CatSalut before you renew.

If you do need to buy

Sanitas, ASISA and DKV offer student products in Barcelona. All three advertise no-copay options without waiting periods, issue a Spanish certificate and price by quote.

Compare **total payable** and cancellation rules; check for an English-speaking GP nearby.

Referral disclosure: we may receive a referral fee from some insurers, including Sanitas. ASISA and DKV pay us nothing. We quote no prices for any of them, so this page recommends none. Get three quotes and pick on the criteria above. If we later help you buy, we'll tell you then whether we're paid on it.

10 · PRACTICALITIES **EVERYONE**

What the admin costs, and the two accounts you need

Not a cost-of-living page. Just the money the paperwork takes, and what you need working to pay it.

The paperwork, start to finish

Total, non-EU: **€80-160**

Fee 790-012, EU registration	EU		€12.00
Fee 790-012, TIE	NON-EU		€16.08
Padrón registration	ALL	FREE	€0
Passport photos, 32x26 mm	NON-EU		€6-12
Photocopies	ALL		€5-10
T-mobilitat card + 90-day T-jove	UNDER 30		€46.50-50
Insurance, if you must buy	SOME		€0-65

€0 €20 €40 €60

 Fixed / minimum  Up to

Government fees confirmed against the current fee schedule. The padrón really is free: anyone charging you is charging for their time, not the registration.

A bank account

You need one that does three things: **pays the fee, receives money from home, pays your rent.**

A Spanish IBAN isn't legally required for a SEPA payment; an account in another EU country shouldn't be refused for that alone. In practice, **some landlords and most utility direct debits want an ES IBAN**, so get one if you can.

At every ATM and card terminal, choose euros. Offered your home currency? Decline. That's dynamic currency conversion, and it's usually worse.

A Spanish number

Prepaid works on a passport. Contract plans generally want a NIE, which you may not have yet.

You want a +34 number for appointment SMS and deliveries. A data-only travel eSIM often gives you no number at all.

"€10 every 28 days" isn't €10 a month. A 28-day cycle renews about thirteen times a year.

Monthly  12×28-day  13×

Keep access to your home SIM until your bank stops sending codes to it.

11 · EARNING EVERYONE

Working while you study

The question everyone asks after the TIE. The answer recently changed in your favour.

30 h

a week, no separate permit

Old rule

20h

Now

30h

Under **RD 1155/2024**, students in higher education may work up to 30 hours a week without a separate work permit. Older guidance online says 20 hours or says you need a permit. **Check the date on anything you read.**

2

conditions

The work must be **compatible with your studies**. And your employer needs to see your card or authorisation **before you start**: they carry the risk if you can't evidence your status.

Post-compulsory vocational training follows different rules: formative practice, not general employment.

1

catch: your health cover

Starting work means Social Security affiliation, which can replace the private insurance your authorisation required.

Don't cancel a policy without checking your own authorisation conditions first. But do check: some students pay for cover they no longer need.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON EVERYONE

Put these in your calendar now

Every date in this guide that can quietly bite you, in one place. Write yours in.

DEADLINE	WHO	RULE	MY DATE
Apply for your TIE	NON-EU	Within 1 month of entry (or of your favourable resolution, if you applied in Spain)	
EU registration	EU	Within 3 months of entry	
Health policy ends	EVERYONE	Must cover your full authorised period, not just the academic year	
Padrón renewal	NON-EU	Every 2 years without long-term residence. Lapses silently.	
T-jove runs out	UNDER 30	90 consecutive days from your first tap, not 90 days of use	
Authorisation expires	NON-EU	No appointment yet as this gets close? Talk to a professional (p.10)	
Card collection	NON-EU	Ask at your appointment. Don't book flights around a guess.	

12 • AT THE COUNTER **EVERYONE**

Admin-day survival

[SCREENSHOT THIS PAGE](#)

The only page you need on you. Print it or save it to your phone.

Say this

SPANISH	ENGLISH
<i>Tengo cita para...</i>	I have an appointment for...
<i>¿Qué documentos me faltan?</i>	Which documents am I missing?
<i>¿Necesito el certificado o el volante?</i>	Do I need the certificate or the volante?
<i>¿Puede hablar más despacio?</i>	Could you speak more slowly?
<i>¿Me lo puede dar por escrito?</i>	Could you give it to me in writing?
<i>¿Cuál es mi número de expediente?</i>	What is my file number?
<i>Necesito ayuda. ¿Habla inglés?</i>	I need help. Do you speak English?

Emergency numbers

112	Police, fire, medical. Free, 24/7.
061	Salut Respon: health guidance, Catalonia
092	Guàrdia Urbana, local police
017	INCIBE: online fraud

Office hours aren't your hours

Most offices serve the public **mornings only**, and many close entirely in **August** and around public holidays. Check the specific office's hours the day before.

A 09:30 appointment is not a 09:30 arrival. Arrive early.

Catalan and Spanish

Both are official. Municipal websites often default to Catalan; look for the language switch, usually top right. The Spanish version is occasionally less complete.

Last-minute check

- ☐ Originals **and** paper copies
- ☐ 790 form **paid and stamped**
- ☐ Appointment confirmation + expediente number
- ☐ Names match on every document

13 · THE HONEST PART EVERYONE

Do it yourself, or hand it over?

No opinions, just counts: documents to produce, separate systems to use, and times you physically show up during office hours.

How much admin each task creates

From the official checklists, non-EU route

■ Documents ■ Systems / portals ■ In-person visits

TIE application	9	3	2	14 items
EU certificate	6	3	1	10 items
Padrón	4	1	1	6 items
Travel pass setup	1	2	1	4 items
Bank account	3	1		4 items

Local offices may ask for more. Documents counted are the nine on the page 8 checklist. The three in-person visits on the cover: padrón counter, fingerprint appointment, and card collection where a second visit is required.

ALL OF THIS IS DOABLE ALONE

Thousands of students do it every September with patience and this kind of checklist. It's free and it's official. If you have time in your first fortnight and a bit of Spanish, **do it yourself**. We'd rather you kept your money.

WHO TENDS TO HIRE US

- One-year programme with no slack in it
- You don't speak Spanish
- You arrived in the September crush, clock running
- You've already lost one appointment
- Your landlord is difficult about the padrón

None of those you? Use the checklists and keep your money.

Why two prices

The EU route is less work, so it costs less: no fingerprints, no €16.08 fee, and the certificate is normally issued at the appointment. Non-EU means EX-17, the biometric appointment, and at some offices a second collection trip.

We confirm your route at triage, **before you pay anything**.

What it costs

Two fixed-fee packages: **The Ready File** from **€49** and **The Soft Landing** from **€99** (EU route; non-EU is €79 and €149). Nothing is billed hourly, and government fees are never included.

A wrong appointment type costs you the slot and puts you back in a queue nobody can predict.

Page 18 shows what each package includes.

Not sure? Free triage, same day. Which route, how many days left, what's recoverable.

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14 · WHAT IT COSTS

EVERYONE

Two packages, fixed fees

The Soft Landing includes everything in The Ready File. Prices are EU / EEA / Swiss first, then non-EU, and exclude IVA.

Government fees are never included.
Nothing is billed hourly.
21% IVA is added at checkout.

The Ready File
You book your own appointments
€49 / €79
EU / NON-EU

MOST CHOSEN
The Soft Landing
+ we hunt your appointment
€99 / €149
EU / NON-EU

THE PAPERWORK · BOTH PACKAGES

Route confirmed against your own authorisation	✓	✓
Your form (EX-17 or EX-18), generated, print-ready and cross-checked	✓	✓
Modelo 790 Código 012, set for cash, plus a named bank branch	✓	✓
Padrón file, for the right town hall	✓	✓
Authorisation form if the flat isn't in your name	✓	✓
Completeness audit, including the name-match check	✓	✓
Step-by-step booking guide for the official portal	✓	✓
The whole file as a print-at-home PDF, the moment it's assembled	✓	✓

WE TAKE IT FROM THERE · THE SOFT LANDING

Appointments searched and booked in your name, with a dated itinerary	—	✓
WhatsApp line in English for 30 days	—	✓
Live line during your appointment	—	✓
Bank and transit setup guides	—	✓

OPTIONAL ADD-ONS · EITHER PACKAGE · EXCL. IVA

T-jove Transit Pass (90 days) €65

We create your T-mobilitat account, verify your ID and load a 90-day unlimited youth pass. Under 30 only.

Carnet Jove Activation €19

The official Catalan youth card: application, fee payment and digital activation.

ISIC Digital Student ID €20

The International Student Identity Card, issued against your enrolment letter.

Spanish eSIM Setup (+34 number) €25

A local Spanish number with 50-100 GB of data, ready before you land.

IF THE SLOT NEVER COMES

On The Soft Landing we search the official portal for up to six weeks. If nothing opens, you get **50% of the package fee back** and keep the entire Ready File.

ONE THING WE WILL NEVER DO

We will never register you at an address you don't live at. That's a fraud problem attached to your immigration file.

15 · READ BEFORE YOU BUY **EVERYONE**

The honest notes

Six things that go wrong when nobody says them out loud first.

01



The 790 arrives unpaid, and it has to

It's a barcoded form that must be paid and stamped at a bank counter or scanner. Paying online needs a Spanish digital certificate you don't have yet. We configure, print and tell you where; **the trip is yours**. An unstamped form ends the appointment.

02



Our copies are printed, not certified

We print from the scans you upload. We've never seen your original passport and can't certify anything. **You carry the originals**; the folder carries what goes with them.

03



We can't make an appointment exist

On The Soft Landing we search the official portal for up to **six weeks**. If none opens, you get **50% of the package fee back** and keep the entire Ready File, so you're ready the day one does. On The Ready File you book your own, with our guide. Nobody can shortcut this legally.

04



We don't attend the biometric appointment for you

It requires you, in person, with originals. We prepare and brief you, and on The Soft Landing we also book it and stay reachable by phone. **The appearance is yours, in your own name.**

05



Your 90 days start when you tap

The T-jove add-on's window runs from first validation, not purchase. But it's **90 consecutive days** once it starts, not 90 days of use.

06



T-jove is an age rule, not a student rule

Under 30 only; no student card needed. Thirty or over, leave the add-on unticked: the right pass is a **T-usual** for the zones you need, and we can point you to it.

IF YOUR WINDOW HAS ALREADY CLOSED

Past the deadline, on an expired or irregular status, or facing a refusal: that needs legal analysis we're not qualified to give. **We'll say so at triage and point you to a *colegiado abogado***, and we won't take your money.

Never in the fee

- ✗ Modelo 790 Código 012 and card issuance: paid by you, directly, at a bank
- ✗ Tuition, rent, deposits: we never handle funds for third parties
- ✗ Legal representation or appeals: outside our scope
- ✗ Sworn translation or apostille: we identify what needs it and refer you to a *traductor jurado*

Paying us

Prices exclude IVA: **21% is added at checkout**, and you see the total before you pay. Nothing is billed hourly.

Your documents are stored encrypted and **permanently deleted 30 days after your service completes**, or earlier on request.

We don't guarantee appointments, and we don't give legal advice.

START HERE · FREE · SAME DAY

Where do you actually stand today?

Send us your entry stamp, your authorisation and your enrolment letter. We'll tell you **which route applies, how many days you have left, and what's still recoverable**. No charge, no obligation, and if you don't need us we'll say so.



SCAN FOR FREE TRIAGE

bcnstudent.com

SOURCES

IMMIGRATION

Ministry: student authorisations
 Interior Ministry: TIE requirements
 National Police: EX-17, EX-18
 Official appointment portal · fee
 790-012

CITY AND PADRÓN

Barcelona City Council:
 empadronament
 Alta al Padró municipal:
 requirements
 T-mobilitat: T-jove fare and zones
 CatSalut: obtaining a TSI

RULES CITED

Photo 32×26 mm: Ministerio
 del Interior
 30 hours' work: RD 1155/2024
 Padrón renewal, 2 years: ENCSARP
 Falsification: Código Penal art. 392

Emergencies

112 police, fire, medical · **061** Salut Respon · **092** Guàrdia Urbana · **017** INCIBE
 online fraud

Verified per section, not globally. Government fees and transport fares update on different cycles: fees checked 10 Sept 2026 against the current fee schedule; ATM fares checked 10 Sept 2026 and next reviewed 15 Jan 2027, when Catalan fares change; padrón rules checked 10 Sept 2026. Prices are in euros and change without notice. Recommendations are editorial judgments about convenience and suitability, not guarantees. Always use the official procedure page for current conditions before you pay anything or attend an appointment.

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